

The Glow-Up Kit — Resume & LinkedIn

6 ATS-friendly templates + the full optimization playbook

THE FRESHMAN/SOPHOMORE RESUME (NO EXPERIENCE)

The #1 mistake: waiting until you have "real experience." Here's how to build a strong resume from day one.

SECTIONS TO INCLUDE (no experience version)

- !Education (put this FIRST — it's your main credential right now)
- !Relevant Coursework (yes, this is valid if it's actually relevant)
- !Projects (class projects count — describe them like work experience)
- !Leadership & Activities (clubs, sports, student government, volunteering)
- !Skills (software, languages, tools you actually know)
- !Work Experience (any job counts — tutoring, retail, babysitting, landscaping)

EDUCATION SECTION FORMAT

University Name, City, State

Degree Program — Expected Graduation: May 20XX

GPA: 3.X/4.0 (only include if 3.0 or above)

Relevant Coursework: [list 4-6 courses related to job]

Honors: Dean's List, Honors Program, Scholarships (if applicable)

BULLET POINT FORMULA (use this for everything)

Action verb + What you did + How/With what + Result/Impact

WEAK: "Helped with social media"

STRONG: "Managed Instagram account for 200-person student organization, growing followers by 45% in one semester through daily content strategy"

WEAK: "Worked at restaurant"

STRONG: "Served 50+ customers per shift at high-volume restaurant, consistently ranked top performer in speed and accuracy by floor manager"

POWER VERBS BY CATEGORY

LEADERSHIP:

Led, Managed, Directed, Supervised, Coordinated, Oversaw, Spearheaded, Championed, Mentored, Delegated

TECHNICAL:

Developed, Engineered, Programmed, Designed, Implemented, Built, Automated, Optimized, Analyzed, Configured

COMMUNICATION:

Presented, Wrote, Edited, Published, Pitched, Persuaded, Facilitated, Negotiated, Communicated, Authored

RESULTS:

Increased, Reduced, Improved, Saved, Generated, Grew, Achieved, Exceeded, Delivered, Accelerated

ATS (APPLICANT TRACKING SYSTEM) GUIDE

75% of resumes are rejected by ATS software before a human sees them. Here's how to beat it:

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LINKEDIN PROFILE OPTIMIZATION CHECKLIST

PROFILE PHOTO (gets 14x more views)

- !" Professional but not stuffy (business casual is fine)
- !" Your face fills 60% of the frame
- !" Solid or blurred background
- !" Good lighting — face the light source
- !" Smile — you seem more approachable

HEADLINE (most important line — always visible in search)

- !"Bad: "Student at University of Texas"
- !"Better: "Computer Science Student | Aspiring Software Engineer | Python & Java"
- !"Formula: [Role/Student] | [Target Career] | [2-3 Key Skills]
- !"Include keywords recruiters search for in your target field

ABOUT SECTION (your pitch in 3 paragraphs)

- !"Paragraph 1: Who you are + what you study + what drives you
- !"Paragraph 2: Your relevant experience, skills, and what makes you different
- !"Paragraph 3: What you're looking for (internships, full-time, collaborations)
- !"End with: "Feel free to reach out at [email]"
- !"Include keywords naturally throughout — this is searchable

EXPERIENCE SECTION

- !"Use the same bullet formula as your resume
- !"Include ALL experience — nothing is too small
- !"Add media: screenshots, PDFs of projects, certificates
- !"Keep dates accurate — recruiters check these

SKILLS & CONNECTIONS

- !"Add 5-10 relevant skills (they appear in recruiter searches)
- !"Get endorsements from classmates, professors, supervisors
- !"Connect with everyone you meet: classmates, professors, speakers at events
- !"Send personalized connection requests: "Hi [name], I'm a [year] at [school] studying [major]. I'd love to connect — your work in [field] is inspiring."
- !"500+ connections makes your profile look established

COVER LETTER FRAMEWORK

Paragraph 1 (Opening Hook): Why this company specifically? Show you've researched them. Not "I am applying for..."

Paragraph 2 (Experience): Your most relevant experience. Use 1-2 specific examples with results.

Paragraph 3 (Connection): Why you + this company = perfect fit. What problem do you solve for them?

Paragraph 4 (Close): Confident ask for interview. "I would love the opportunity to discuss how I can contribute to [team/project]."

Keep it under 350 words. Use the exact job title. Customize the first and last paragraphs for each application.

